GUEST GUIDE · SUNDAY 25 OCTOBER 2026

Linh & Huy

The wedding · *Lễ Vu Quy*

Sunday 25 October 2026
09:00

The bride's family home
550 Trần Hưng Đạo Street, Phủ Lý Ward, Ninh Bình

"Vu quy" literally means "the daughter goes to her husband's home". Held at the bride's family home, this ceremony marks the moment Linh says goodbye to her ancestors and her parents to start a family with Huy. It is an emotional moment, followed by a big celebration meal.

ARRIVAL
9:00 am at the house — the ceremony starts at 10:00 am

LENGTH
About 40 minutes of ceremony, then the reception from 10:40 am

DRESS
Dressy and colourful (an áo dài is very welcome). Avoid all-white, kept for the bride, and all-black

GIFT
Nothing to bring or give on the day

> ***The ancestral altar*** — It holds the place of honour in every Vietnamese home. Before leaving her family, the bride announces her marriage to her ancestors there: it is the spiritual heart of the day.

Getting there on Sunday

COMING FROM HANOI
Organised coach (booking required): leaves Keangnam (Phạm Hùng) at 7:45 am, returns from Phủ Lý at 2:00 pm.

ALREADY IN PHỦ LÝ
No coach needed: come straight to the bride's family home, 550 Trần Hưng Đạo Street, at 9:00 am.

At the table

- Dishes are shared in the middle of the table: use the serving chopsticks if there are some.
- Wait for the elders to start, or to be invited to eat ("Mời!").
- Never stand your chopsticks upright in your rice: that gesture belongs to funeral rites.
- Toasts are frequent, often with beer: toasting with a soft drink is perfectly fine.

Good to know

- Give and receive things (cup, glass, dish) with both hands.
- Greet the elders first.
- You may be asked to take your shoes off inside the house: wear shoes that slip off easily.
- Photos are welcome, but never in front of the altar during the rites.

Weather & practical

- Late October in Ninh Bình: around 22–29 °C, humid, showers possible. Bring a light jacket and an umbrella.
- Keep some cash in Vietnamese dong (VND) on you.

A few words

Rough pronunciation in brackets — any effort will be warmly appreciated!

Xin chào *(sin chow)*
Hello

Cảm ơn *(gahm uhn)*
Thank you

Chúc mừng! *(chook mung)*
Congratulations!

Trăm năm hạnh phúc *(chum num hahn fook)*
"A hundred years of happiness" — the classic wish to newlyweds

Một, hai, ba, dzô! *(mote, hi, ba, yo)*
"One, two, three, cheers!" — the toast

Ngon quá! *(ngon kwah)*
Delicious!

Cô dâu · Chú rể *(koh yoh · choo zeh)*
The bride · the groom

Nhà trai · Nhà gái *(nyah chai · nyah guy)*
Groom's family · bride's family

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What happens

07:45

ONLY IF YOU ARE COMING FROM HANOI

Coach leaves Hanoi

Meet at Keangnam (Phạm Hùng, Hanoi). The coach drives to Phủ Lý (about 1 h 15) and drops you off in time for the 9:00 welcome.

YOUR PART Please be on time: the coach can't wait. Already in Phủ Lý? Skip straight to 9:00.

09:00

Guests arrive

All guests meet at Linh's parents' home, whether they come by coach or on their own, and are welcomed with tea.

YOUR PART Greet the bride's parents, then sit where you are shown.

The groom's family arrives

Huy's family arrives in procession, with a tray of betel and liquor, to ask to "welcome the bride". The two families' spokespeople exchange a few words.

YOUR PART Let the procession through and keep the entrance clear.

10:00

Ceremony at the altar

The couple lights incense and bows before the ancestral altar to announce their marriage and ask for a blessing.

YOUR PART Quiet and discreet: stay back from the altar.

Thanks and the parents' blessing

The couple thanks Linh's parents, who share their advice for married life. Parents and relatives then give the bride gold jewellery, a gesture of protection and support.

YOUR PART The most moving moment — tears are common. Applaud when everyone applauds.

10:40

Reception

The celebration meal begins, often with a group toast. During the meal, the couple goes from table to table to drink with every guest.

YOUR PART Raise your glass with them: "Một, hai, ba, dzô!"

14:00

ONLY IF YOU ARE GOING BACK TO HANOI

Coach back to Hanoi

Vietnamese receptions are short (about two hours) and it is normal to leave soon after the meal. The coach goes back from Phủ Lý to Keangnam; guests staying in Phủ Lý leave whenever they like.

YOUR PART Before you go, say goodbye to the couple's parents: "Cảm ơn!"

Trăm năm hạnh phúc